

Amber



What is golden like honey and shines like glass? Amber! The Ancient Greeks thought it was droplets of solid sunlight. In fact, it comes from trees. Pine and fir trees ooze a thick, sticky liquid called resin if their bark is damaged. The resin drips out to plug any cuts, and then hardens. Just like a dinosaur bone, the resin can fossilize, transforming into amber.

Amber can be a time capsule to the prehistoric world. If a spider or insect walks across the golden goo when it is still sticky, it can get trapped. As the resin turns to amber, the creepy-crawly is trapped forever, and we can see it as it was millions of years ago.

*One rare type of amber is orange until
seen in sunlight, when it turns blue!*

